

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 609

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Deputy Governor Butch Eley on his service to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their careers in public service; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Butch Eley, who has served the State of Tennessee with distinction for nearly seven years of leadership in Governor Bill Lee's cabinet and most recently served as Deputy Governor and Commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Transportation; and

WHEREAS, Deputy Governor Butch Eley has been a key figure in advancing statewide infrastructure, financial stewardship, and government modernization; he played a leading role in the Hurricane Helene recovery effort and the passage of the Transportation Modernization Act; and

WHEREAS, Deputy Governor Eley began his service in the Lee administration as Chief Operating Officer, overseeing twenty-three departments and 35,000 employees, during which tenure he led the implementation of Tennessee's first four-year strategic planning process; and

WHEREAS, next appointed to the position of Commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Finance and Administration, he served as the State's Chief Financial Officer and oversaw the establishment of the largest general fund in State history and guided Tennessee through an unprecedented economic crisis during the COVID-19 pandemic; and

WHEREAS, during his second term, Governor Bill Lee appointed Butch Eley Commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Transportation in order to prepare the Volunteer State's infrastructure for its extraordinary economic growth; and

WHEREAS, Deputy Governor Eley exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career with the State of Tennessee, Butch Eley has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues and a grateful public; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we extend to Deputy Governor Butch Eley our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement from public service, offering our deepest gratitude for his dedicated service to the State of Tennessee and wishing him every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.